

Outlook

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Quick question: analytics needs a source-of-truth decision

Morning,

I need help with something that sounds simple but probably is not.

A requested analysis changes depending on whether the team starts from transaction, debit-order, account-status or customer-contact records. The operating teams agree that more journeys are failing; they disagree on whether the customer, the bank or a downstream party owns the failure. Different teams have produced different answers from the same period, so population and timing rules need to be visible.

The questions I would ask in the room are:

1. What would we expect to see if one source is updated retrospectively?
2. What evidence would instead support that the sources record different stages of one event?
3. How do we rule out that matching logic is joining unrelated records?

This has returned because the previous answer was useful but not strong enough to become a standing rule. Use June 2021 as the new evidence point rather than recycling the earlier conclusion. Please work towards the source precedence rule and the cases that must remain explicitly unresolved. A useful output would be a one-page finding note plus the underlying CSV for our own review.

Use transaction-level timestamps, channels, amounts, statuses and error context; debit-order mandates, collection dates, suspensions and cancellations; monthly account snapshots, status events, limits, product enrolments and signatories; customer contacts, complaints and suggestions. One caution: Do not force agreement by dropping exceptions; preserve contradictory evidence for owner review.

Regards